

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 963

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Sally Yoho Swaney.

WHEREAS, it was with great sadness that the members of this General Assembly learned of the passing of our former colleague Sally Yoho Swaney, who we will fondly remember as an accomplished attorney, trusted advisor, and treasured friend; and

WHEREAS, a mainstay of the Office of Legal Services for the General Assembly from 1978 to 2013, Sally Swaney served as legal counsel for numerous legislative committees, most notably and memorably the House State and Local Government Committee; and

WHEREAS, Sally Swaney was renowned throughout the Capitol complex for her benevolence in helping members, lobbyists, staff, and citizens alike navigate the legislative process; even though her workload was usually heavy, she was never too busy to help others, and this kindness earned her a special place in the hearts of her work family; and

WHEREAS, among her Legal Services colleagues, she was a valuable resource and a sagacious mentor; not only was her legal knowledge extensive, she always thought like a lawyer, and she expected other attorneys to apply the same careful attention to the devilish details of the law; and

WHEREAS, most of all, Sally Swaney was a person of integrity, and she earned the respect of legislators from both poles of the political spectrum and all stops in between; she was always fair and never biased in presenting her legal opinions; and

WHEREAS, a native of Energy, Pennsylvania, Sara "Sally" Yoho was the second-youngest of the seven children in her family; and

WHEREAS, growing up in post-World War II America, Sally Yoho was forced to walk a mile to attend Castlewood Elementary School, regardless of the weather, be it snow sleet, rain,

or sunshine; in later life, she enjoyed sharing this legendary anecdote with her friends, family, and the entire world on a frequent basis; and

WHEREAS, by the time Sally reached the sixth grade, she and her siblings were able to ride the bus to Shenango High School, and they were extremely grateful for this landmark improvement in transportation that swapped heels for wheels; and

WHEREAS, Sally Yoho and her siblings spent the halcyon days of their childhood in the traditional pursuits of playing ball, playing hide-and-seek in the woods, climbing trees, and ice skating on a nearby pond, and they even learned to walk on stilts; and

WHEREAS, after graduating as salutatorian of her high school class, Sally Yoho worked her way through college, earning her bachelor's degree from Geneva College; and

WHEREAS, she then attended law school at Ohio Northern University while working at the local bank; it was there that she met Donald "Don" A. Swaney, who she later married; and

WHEREAS, leaving Pennsylvania, Don and Sally Swaney first relocated to Washington, D.C., before moving to Nashville, where they made their forever home and had their only child, David A. Swaney; and

WHEREAS, Sally Swaney then sat for and passed the Tennessee bar exam; soon thereafter, she was hired as an attorney for the Office of Legal Services for the General Assembly, thus beginning her thirty-four-year journey with this legislative body; and

WHEREAS, Sally's whole world revolved around her family and those fortunate ones she treasured as family; she especially loved being "Mimi" to her grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, Sally Swaney enjoyed playing golf, taking road trips with her sisters, and attending Barbershop Quartet competitions; at home, she loved cross-stitching and spent more than five years completing a five-panel Nativity scene; and

WHEREAS, Sally Swaney was respected by all as a person of deep and abiding faith, and she found great joy singing in the choir at Cook's United Methodist Church for more than twenty years; and

WHEREAS, Sally Swaney's influence will live on in each life she touched; this remarkable lady is survived by her son, David A. Swaney; her daughter-in-law, Tricia; her grandchildren, Logan and Caitlyn; her younger sister, Susan Colella; her sister-in-law, Norma Yoho; her brother-in-law, John M. Roth; and dozens of nieces, nephews, grandnieces, grandnephews, and great-grandnieces and great-grandnephews; and

WHEREAS, she was preceded in death by her parents, John E. and Catharine Irene Yoho; her husband, Donald "Don" A. Swaney; and her siblings Neil, Jean, John, Ray, and Leann; and

WHEREAS, Sally Swaney is mourned by a community of friends and colleagues and a large and loving family, and we wish to pay our respects to a life spent in devoted service to God and family; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we celebrate the life of Sally Yoho Swaney, even as we honor her memory and mourn her passing, remembering the purposeful life of a humble Christian who accomplished much and was beloved by many.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our condolences to Mrs. Swaney's family and many friends.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.

